Session 55

2026-10-11

1 – Outside the lodge

~22:00, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. The party is dispersed around the hunting lodge. **Mialee** still has several minutes of Amidamaru's invisibility running on her; Nuberroca works along the back of the house with Nyx one step behind him so she can relay signals back to Amidamaru; The tortle hangs back at the tree-line with Eguzkilore, a lit pebble on him from his tinkering; Sinsong, with the dwarf **Tharn**, waits at the front step, and right behind awaits Kaelthar with his summoned dire-wolf.
2. Through the kitchen window Nuberroca catches the cooks grumbling that the lady of the house is expecting visitors and extra plates have to go out; from a cleaner line Nyx picks out **Talis the White** and a rivalry mentioned without a name. She half-recalls the rival as *Borngray*, and later Amidamaru places the man as **Dralmorrer Borngray** — "elegant and racist" elf, the lieutenant of castle Naerytar.
3. The group gathers back in the pines and agrees on a cover: they walk in as reinforcements Dralmorrer has sent for the goblin problem, Harper and Torm insignias stowed or covered, cultist cloaks over their shoulders. Amidamaru hangs a dragon-chain openly at his neck; Nuberroca remains outside with Kaelthar's wolf, wary of eyes among the trees; weapons go sheathed before the door.

2 – The chief butler

~22:10, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. In the gloom of the entry hall, with no-one yet come down to meet them, Mialee, still invisible, raps three times at an inner door to see who comes, and nobody comes at all. A few minutes later Sinsong decides to try the horn of the great mounted elk on the north wall — Kaelthar lifts him by the waist to reach it, he cannot work it loose, only knocks the trophy skew, and nudges it straight again with a conjured hand.
2. The door-keeper eventually comes — a human steward in formal dress — **Gastyn**. The hall is near-dark; Gastyn rounds on a kobold to light the lamps, and when the first lamp is not enough he orders every lamp lit, muttering "cursed useless things" under his breath.
3. Sinsong ignores the plan and improvises — they are the escort of the Great Tharn, the finest cook in the realm — and Gastyn, visibly puzzled but unwilling to argue, waves Tharn to the kitchen and offers the party two guest rooms and a hall to lounge in.
4. As Gastyn starts to dismiss them to their rooms, Nyx adds the real pretext: they come from Dralmorrer with business for Talis. Gastyn politely insists the cook's escort's business is not his concern, but says he will tell Talis they are here.
5. Over the course of the conversation Gastyn volunteers that the previous master was **Lord Marsten**, a hunter, and on Nyx's question admits the handover to Talis came only a few months back. The party reads him as fonder of the old master and sour on the new one.
6. Only well after the others have been settled does Nuberroca finally come in from the cold; Gastyn stops him at the threshold and asks who he is — he answers "escort of the cook's escort" and Gastyn, after a tired glance at his muddy boots, has him leave them at the step before coming in.

3 – The sitting room

~22:30, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Upstairs, invisible, Mialee turns over an armoury — a rain-wet room with a hole in the roof and a rack of cheap arms — and quietly cleans it out of its valuables.
2. In the next room over she finds a vaulted hall with five tapestries: four depict chromatic dragons, each razing a different location (a desert caravan under a blue, elves gasping at a green's poison, a putrid marsh ringed by a black and a white, Waterdeep's guard-castle burning under a red), and dominating the south wall between two hearths, a gold-thread Tiamat of five heads, thirty-five by twenty feet, gem-set and worth a fortune. She leaves the tapestries untouched and comes back down.
3. Back in the sitting room, Sinsong asks Nyx to lift him up to touch the horn of the metal-faced bull head mounted on the wall; Nyx tries, but she is a halfling trying to lift a dwarf — between them they barely reach Nuberroca's waist. Nuberroca steps in instead, grabs the head and pulls it off the wall himself. Its skull turns out to be real metal, not stuffed, and the back of the wooden mount hides nothing he can find on first inspection; he re-fastens it to the wall.
4. Moments later Nuberroca takes the bull head down again and drops it onto Sinsong — *"toma"* — and the dwarf buckles to the floor under the metal weight.
5. Gastyn returns with a bar of incense requested by Amidamaru, scolds Nuberroca into putting the bull head back, and asks them to behave themselves and not burn the house down.
6. Amidamaru settles by the hearth and begins the long summon of his owl **Munin**. Shortly after, **Arlaenga** — the house maid, a mature brown-haired woman — lets herself into the sitting-room and takes a corner post "in case the guests need anything".
7. Sinsong tries his luck at Arlaenga's shoulder with a whispered proposition and earns an open-handed slap that leaves five finger-marks on the dwarf's face and a direct instruction not to come near her again. The owl finally lifts out of the hearth; Arlaenga stiffens at the bird, insists animals do not come inside, and Amidamaru lets Munin out through the window after a brief argument.
8. The tortle settles into a quiet corner of the hearth and reads the room for magic: Mialee shines as a sun bright with light; Sinsong's old neck-scar glows; Nyx's only glow is the scroll Amidamaru gave her the week before; the goodberries each of them carries are their own small lights, but the room seems empty of anything magical.
9. The Thayan sword Amidamaru has stashed in his gear reads as magical, and further inspection reveals it could bond with a wizard but, afraid of a possible curse, he decides against taking it on.

4 – A mounted griffon

~23:00, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. Sinsong, scanning the trophy wall, snaps and recognises the mounted griffon head above as *Targutai*, the mount he lost — and from then on cannot be moved off it, repeating the name through dinner between forkfuls. Nyx and Mialee cannot talk Sinsong down. Arlaenga, over the course of the back-and-forth, lets slip that Lord Marsten had died in a hunting accident.
2. Two kobolds open the door with a kick and bring dinner in on balanced plates, Arlaenga closing the door behind them. Mialee moves to check the food for poison, but Sinsong jumps in — sobbing through the grief he casts a detection spell and finds nothing.
3. The moment Arlaenga leaves to fetch some wine from the kitchen, the party moves — on Sinsong's insistence Nuberroca lifts the griffon head off the wall for him, and as it hits the table a glass chime sounds from inside. Nuberroca reaches in through the back and pulls out two flasks; Amidamaru fakes the head's shape with a shimmer-illusion where the trophy had been.
4. Nuberroca cracks the window and pitches the real head outside, considering it useless now that the goods are out. When Arlaenga returns with two bottles of wine she sees nothing out of place.

5 – Baths and offerings

~23:20, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. In the sitting-room Nuberroca leans on Arlaenga with an offer — would she take him to bed. She does not slap him — he scares her — only asks, nose wrinkled, to be given some distance from him for what is left of the evening. She slips out at once to fetch Gastyn.
2. The butler returns and, after a last round of courtesies, pulls Nuberroca aside — "blue sir, come with me" — down a narrow passage to a steaming bathing-room with piles of clean towels. Mialee follows him in and climbs into the water on his knees, what happened there only they know.
3. In the meantime Eguzkilore slips out the window, retrieves the thrown griffon head from the mud, and tries to fit it back onto its wooden plate in the sitting-room — it comes back cracked and smeared and the shimmer-illusion stays up over it the rest of the evening.
4. Sinsong, meanwhile, has asked Gastyn for a toilet as an excuse to walk out of the lodge, defecate on the ground in front of the door, and offer the pile aloud to any god listening.

6 – Frozen armour

~23:50, 16 Hammer 1490 DR

1. In the kitchen, clean after the bath, Nuberroca lingers past welcome; the cook politely asks him to leave, and he bargains — give him meat and he will go. The cook splits a raw rabbit in half, sets it over the kitchen fire, and promises it to his room in twenty minutes.
2. The chill drafts drifting through the sitting room owe to the doors Sinsong keeps leaving open on his comings and goings. In the entry hall the cleric, drawn to the two elven-armour stands, wants to try the helmet and, upon touching it, freezes solid where he stands.
3. Nuberroca carries him across to the hearth; five minutes by the fire thaw him out. On his second try at the gauntlet he freezes again, and Nuberroca drags him back a second time.
4. While the dwarf thaws, Nuberroca presses everyone to translate the runes in the spear Mialee had lifted from the upstairs armoury. Only Kaelthar can read the Draconic down the shaft — "the eyes of Tiamat shine" — and the spear begins to glow.
5. Nyx jokes about the weapon from the back of the room — "a lantern" — and Nuberroca's face reflects a barbarian deflation.

7 – The gargoyles stir

~00:00, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. At Sinsong's suggestion to explore the house, Nuberroca steps back into the entry hall spear in hand, while twelve bell-strokes carry down through the house from somewhere upstairs.
2. Suddenly, the two demon-statues flanking the stairs peel off their plinths and go for the barbarian. The first strike glances off him and the second lands; Mialee from the sitting-room doorway puts an arrow into the nearer of the two.
3. Sinsong, braced in the doorway, commands them to flee. One gargoyle shrugs it off; the other beats out of the hall and up to the roof. Nyx, cutting round behind the remaining one and striking from the back, scores a glancing hit.
4. Nuberroca disengages back behind Sinsong at the doorway and stores the spear where no-one can see it.
5. Upstairs a woman in white plate steps out onto the landing with her guards, raises an open palm, speaks one word in a tongue the party does not recognise, and one of the gargoyles returns to its plinth. The other at first flies up instead — raising an eyebrow on the woman's face — before dropping back to its own plinth a few heartbeats later.

8 – Talis the White

~00:10, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. The woman — half-elf, pale-skinned, white plate, a staff of command in one hand and a spear in the other — presents herself as **Talis**. Through her guards and the female cultist posted at the door, she takes the party upstairs to her chamber, where a map of the local mountain country lies open on the table and is folded away the moment they enter.
2. Talis opens with *"Glory to Tiamat"* and the party echoes it. She asks after Dralmorrer and after *Wyrmspeaker* Rezmir, and the party answers vaguely about both. Then she lays out the job: tomorrow morning, find the Nashkag goblin tribe in the surrounding country and finish them — all of them, if they can.
3. She adds that her head of security, **Trepsin**, has already killed thirty or forty of the goblins and that they keep coming; Trepsin is a massive, four-armed, foul-smelling creature, loves his job but prefers to work alone, keeper of her drake-patrols.
4. ***[EPIC]*** From a window Amidamaru watches the same brute walk up to the door — tall, long-armed, moss-skinned, moving fast — and sees him stop short on the step to shake something nasty off a foot. Sinsong's offering had been left exactly there: the brute had trodden straight through it on his way in.
5. Amidamaru makes a request — may they borrow a weapon from the armoury for Sinsong, robbed by the goblins on the road? — and **Kusphia**, the female cultist, is sent to fetch him spears, swords and daggers. The tortle then asks after the Company of the Boar, but Talis has never heard of them.
6. Sinsong oversteps about Tiamat's larger plan and gets kicked under the table by Eguzkilore; Talis reads him as new to the cult and warns the party off dreaming for Dragonwing or Dragonsoul promotions, let alone the purple of a Wyrmspeaker, before they have learned to obey.
7. Kusphia returns through the door empty-handed, slips to Talis's shoulder and murmurs something in her ear the party cannot hear.
8. ***[EPIC]*** On the way out Nyx throws an *"all for Tiamat"*, met with cold looks from the guards and Kusphia. After closing the door Nyx shares with the group that Talis seemed to dislike their replies.

9 – A restless night

~00:30, 17 Hammer 1490 DR

1. The party packs itself into the southern guest room, curtains drawn, window shuttered and only a double bed for six. Amidamaru raises his warded shelter over the whole chamber, ten feet of hidden protection that will see them through the night.
2. They have slept full rests twice already this day, so no third full night will restore them further — only short breathers between the hours of pretending to sleep.
3. Across the night Amidamaru works identifying all the magical objects the party carries. Eguzkilore's cloak is able to change its colour and material, his boots warm against the cold but require him to bond with them; Nuberroca's spear carries only the light-trick they already saw; Amidamaru's Thayan sword is a necromantic blade that drains the wielder's life for extra bite on bonding.
4. In the quiet Nyx asks Sinsong about her near-death vision — a female dwarven figure who steadied her, and a thirst for beer after. The name **Sharindlar** escapes him before he catches himself and begs Nyx never to speak it again; her true name is hidden, and she is to be called the **Lady of Mercy** — the dwarven goddess of healing whose shape matches the figure in Nyx's vision. The thirst for beer, he admits, fits nothing he knows of her.
5. The hours pass with no night excursion, and dawn finds them sleepless but rested, with a mission to eradicate a tribe of goblins they have already met.